

LOOKING CLOSER

Beyond extreme

Some singers have a particularly wide pitch range. A soprano may be able to sing “coloratura,” which involves rapid, brilliantly articulated passages high in the voice, such as that found in the Queen of the Night’s aria in Mozart’s opera *The Magic Flute*. Tenors with strong top notes are also popular in opera, often playing the heroic roles.



Middle C

△ F2 TO G7

Popular American singer Mariah Carey has been known to sing across an incredible range of five octaves.



Middle C

△ F1 TO C4

Some Russian male singers, known as Oktavists, specialize in very low notes, singing an octave lower than the usual bass line.

Performing

Singing is the most popular form of music-making in the world. Groups, choirs, and choruses are found everywhere—in halls, clubs, places of worship, and on recordings—singing all sorts of music. Most choirs are grouped with the four main voice types, and come in sizes ranging from eight to more than one thousand voices.

▽ Choir

Choirs can be grouped in different ways. Normally the higher voices are placed at the front, and the lower voices at the back.

■ Tenors ■ Baritones ■ Basses
■ Sopranos ■ Mezzo-sopranos ■ Altos

